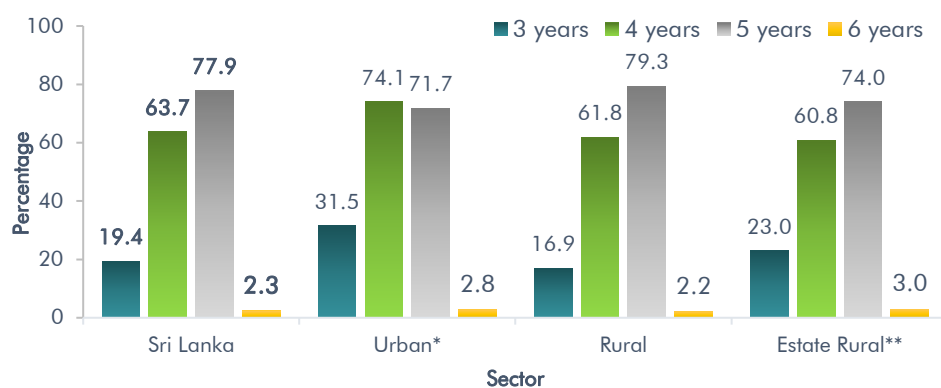




*Although the 2024 Census collected information separately as urban and estate urban, here the two categories are combined and shown as urban.

** The sector identified as 'Estate' in the 2012 Census corresponds to the 'Estate Rural' category in the 2024 Census.

Figure 7.1 : Percentage of Children Attending Preschool by Age and Sector, 2024

As illustrated in Figure 7.1, it is reported that a higher percentage of children aged 3 (31.5%) in the urban sector were engaged in preschool education during the reference period, compared to the rural and estate rural sectors.

Table 7.4 : Percentage of Children Receiving Preschool Education by Age Group and District, 2024

District	Percentage of children in the relevant age group receiving preschool education			
	3 years	4 years	5 years	6 years
Colombo	41.1	82.0	66.9	3.2
Gampaha	34.7	82.4	71.8	2.6
Kalutara	23.3	78.6	77.7	2.5
Kandy	11.8	53.5	78.3	2.0
Matale	9.9	55.5	80.8	2.1
Nuwara Eliya	23.9	65.9	75.3	3.1
Galle	14.1	66.3	80.4	2.1
Matara	12.1	60.3	82.9	1.4
Hambantota	8.6	49.1	80.0	1.7
Jaffna	40.9	84.6	83.8	2.8
Mannar	28.9	74.8	80.4	2.5
Vavuniya	34.8	76.2	77.4	3.6
Mullaitivu	43.3	83.7	81.9	1.9
Kilinochchi	53.7	86.5	85.0	2.7
Batticaloa	20.9	73.5	81.3	2.4
Ampara	10.6	59.6	80.0	2.4
Trincomalee	18.3	61.6	75.4	2.7
Kurunegala	9.8	50.0	81.7	2.2
Puttalam	15.6	62.7	78.6	2.7
Anuradhapura	12.9	60.8	81.4	1.7
Polonnaruwa	13.9	64.8	78.4	2.2
Badulla	14.2	54.1	78.7	2.1
Monaragala	8.9	52.8	81.8	1.4
Rathnapura	8.2	40.6	77.1	2.1
Kegalle	9.0	44.0	79.7	2.1

As given in Table 7.4, when considering all districts, the age of children attending preschool ranges from three to six years. While a very small percentage of children who have completed six years of age is reported across all districts. The Northern and Western provinces show a relatively higher percentage of three-year old engaged in preschool education.